

AI Vendor Evaluation Matrix

Compare AI tools and vendors objectively before you buy

Evaluation Criteria	Vendor A	Vendor B	Vendor C	Vendor D	Score (1-5)
Integration capability					
Data security					
Scalability					
Ease of use					
Support quality					
Pricing transparency					
Training resources					
Vendor lock-in risk					

Scoring: Rate each vendor on each criterion from 1 (poor) to 5 (excellent). Calculate average score per vendor to compare.

How to Use This Matrix

Step 1: List your vendor candidates in the top row

Step 2: For each criterion, rate how well each vendor meets your needs (1-5 scale)

Step 3: Calculate the average score per vendor across all criteria

Step 4: Consider weighted scoring if some criteria matter more (e.g., security = 2x weight)

Step 5: Use quantitative scores plus qualitative judgment to make your final decision

Red Flags When Evaluating Vendors

- Refuses to discuss data security or compliance practices
- No clear pricing model or frequent hidden fees
- Limited or unavailable customer support in your timezone
- Requires long-term contracts with harsh exit penalties
- Poor or outdated documentation and training materials
- Track record of major outages or data breaches
- Unwillingness to sign standard data processing agreements

Want professional guidance? Book a free 30-minute consultation at freshcoastai.com/contact.html